

# Social Tech Intelligence Report 2026

How content consumption shifts across South Africa, North Africa, and global markets — and what it means for brand strategy.

## Executive summary

Recent research indicates that digital media consumption is increasingly mobile-first, video-heavy, and driven by algorithmic discovery. Deloitte's Digital Media Trends (2025) highlights that social content is seen as more relevant than traditional TV for many younger audiences. PwC's Africa Entertainment & Media Outlook (2025–2029) positions South Africa as Africa's largest E&M; market and shows rapid shifts toward digital advertising and video. PwC's Global Entertainment & Media Outlook (2025–2029) projects industry revenue reaching US\$3.5 trillion by 2029, with advertising as a key growth engine.

## Key numbers (latest published figures)

| Region / Country (report year) | Internet users | Social media users (identities) | Notable signal                                      |
|--------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| South Africa (Jan 2025)        | 50.8M (78.9%)  | 26.7M (41.5%)                   | Mobile video dominates; social is core to discovery |
| Egypt (Jan 2025)               | 96.3M (81.9%)  | 50.7M (43.1%)                   | Large scale; strong video + messaging usage         |
| Morocco (Jan 2025)             | 35.3M (92.2%)  | 21.3M (55.5%)                   | High penetration; strong social adoption            |
| Global (2029 forecast)         | —              | —                               | E&M; revenue to US\$3.5T; advertising leads growth  |

### 1) South Africa: what audiences consume most

**Dominant consumption:** short-form video; entrepreneurship and side-hustle content; financial literacy; politics/culture; local creator storytelling.

**Why it matters:** high mobile reach and video-led data usage means brands should design mobile-first funnels and video-led creative.

### 2) North Africa (examples: Egypt, Morocco)

**Dominant consumption:** long-form educational video; culturally aligned content; career and academic advancement; tech tutorials; regional news.

**Why it matters:** stronger tolerance for structured, information-heavy formats supports educational positioning and enterprise enablement.

### 3) Global markets (US/UK/EU): what performs

**Dominant consumption:** AI/emerging tech; productivity systems; personal branding; investing; niche communities.

**Why it matters:** buyers are analytics-driven; ROI proof and case studies outperform generic brand awareness messaging.

## **Strategy: B2B vs B2C positioning**

**B2C** wins with relatability, frequency, and short-form video that simplifies value into lifestyle narratives. **B2B** wins with authority: data-backed insights, case studies, proof-of-work, and clear performance outcomes.

## **Enterprise & gamification**

Enterprise teams increasingly use digital engagement patterns (including gamification) for onboarding, system adoption, training, and compliance. For brands and agencies, this unlocks a new lane: social technology as behavioural infrastructure, not only marketing.

## **Sources (selected)**

- Deloitte Insights — Digital Media Trends 2025 (published Mar 2025).
- PwC South Africa — Africa Entertainment & Media Outlook 2025–2029 (published Oct 2025).
- PwC — Global Entertainment & Media Outlook 2025–2029 (published Jul 2025).
- DataReportal — Digital 2025 reports for South Africa, Egypt, Morocco (published Mar 2025).

Note: DataReportal reports present 'user identities' for social platforms, which may not equal unique individuals. Forecasts are subject to revisions as datasets update.